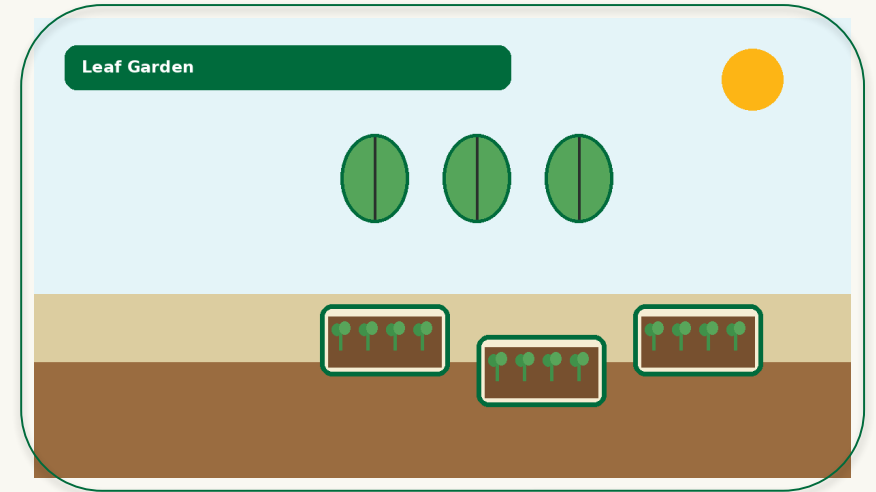


Leaf Garden

Plant Observation and Classification

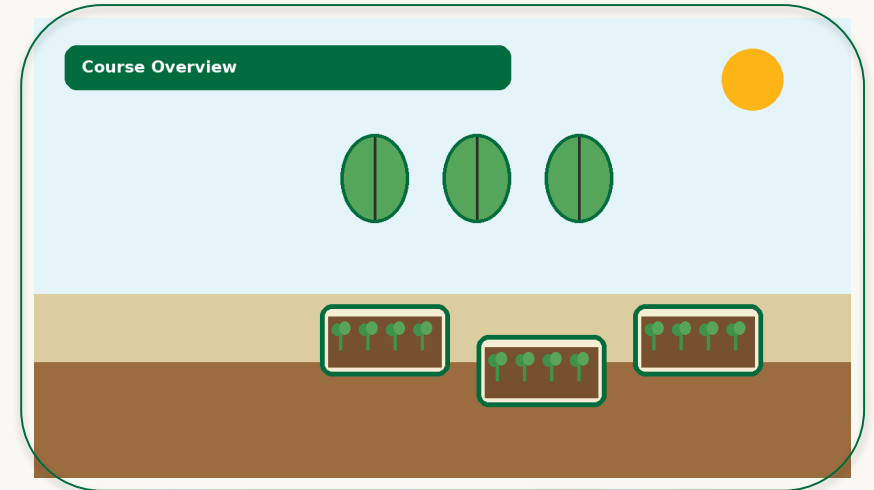
- LIFEWS AgriShine™ GrowMeal™ Primary 1-3 Teacher Training
- Audience: Primary 1-3 teachers, teaching assistants and garden facilitators
- Format: Self-paced online course + supervised practical orientation
- Recommended duration: 3 hours online + 60-90 minutes garden practical



Course Overview

Learning outcomes, materials and teacher readiness

- Learning outcomes: explain the garden's educational and production purpose; teach the ten course topics accurately; connect practical gardening to Primary 1-3 curriculum; supervise age-appropriate garden work; maintain simple records; assess learning through practical and classroom evidence.
- Core materials: teacher guide, crop/word/number cards as relevant, child-safe hand tools, watering equipment, labels, clipboards, rulers/measuring tools where relevant, observation/record sheets, clean harvest containers, handwashing supplies and first-aid access.
- Completion expectation: complete all modules, demonstrate one safe garden lesson, and submit a short lesson/assessment plan.



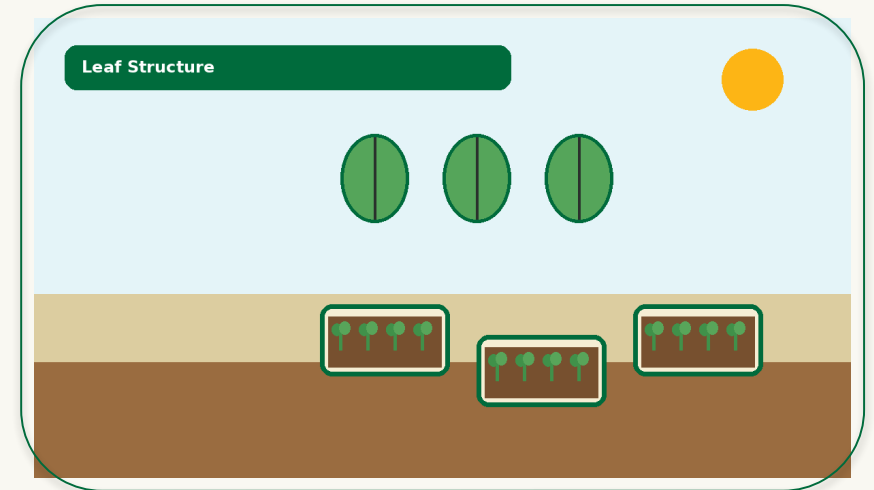
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Training sequence: EXPLAIN → DEMONSTRATE → PRACTISE → RECORD → REFLECT.

Leaf Structure

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Introduce blade, edge, tip, base, stalk/petiole and visible veins using simple diagrams and real leaves.
- Keep terminology appropriate to Primary 1-3 and curriculum expectations.
- Show the leaf attached to the plant before using collected samples.
- Explain that leaves vary greatly among plants.
- Use magnifiers for observation, not for making unsupported diagnoses.



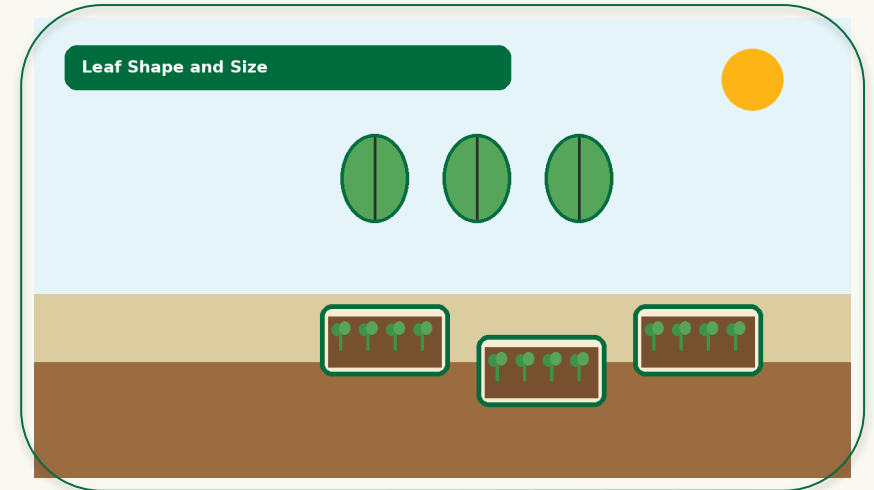
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare one labeled leaf demonstration.

Leaf Shape and Size

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Compare broad, narrow, long, roundish, small and large leaves.
- Measure simple length where appropriate.
- Use more than one leaf from a plant before generalizing about its typical size.
- Sort by a single stated feature.
- Record observations with drawings and labels.



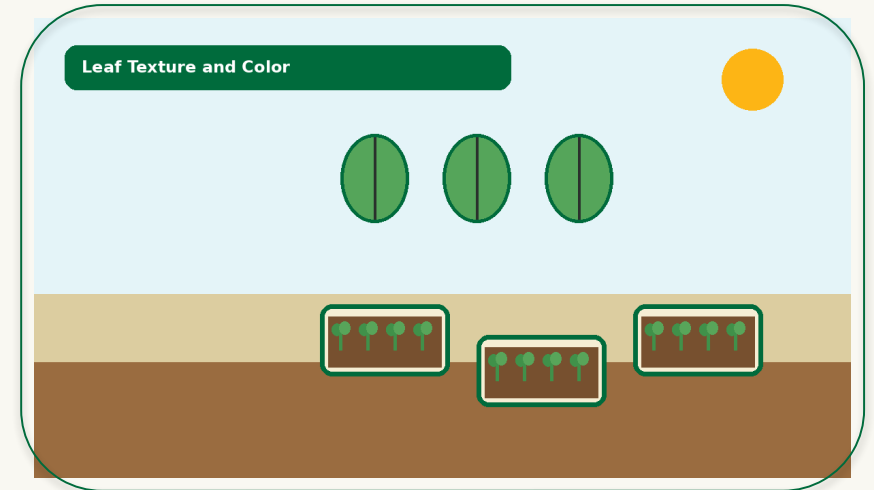
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare four contrasting leaf samples or living plants.

Leaf Texture and Color

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Use descriptive terms such as smooth, rough, soft, firm, glossy and dull.
- Observe different shades and natural color variation.
- Only touch teacher-approved plants.
- Avoid using color alone to decide whether a plant is healthy.
- Connect texture and color descriptions to precise vocabulary.



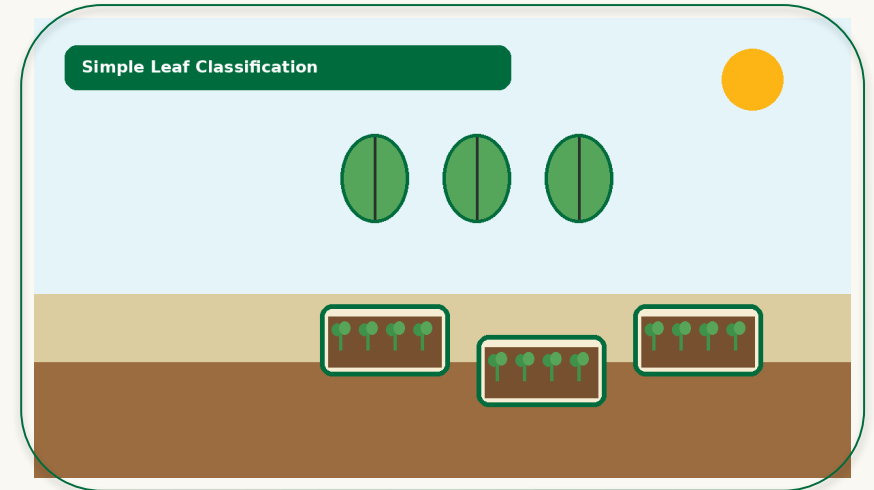
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Select safe leaves for texture comparison.

Simple Leaf Classification

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Classify leaves using observable features selected by the teacher.
- Explain that classification means grouping by shared features.
- Change the rule and regroup the same samples.
- Do not present simple classroom groups as formal botanical taxonomy.
- Ask pupils to explain the rule used.



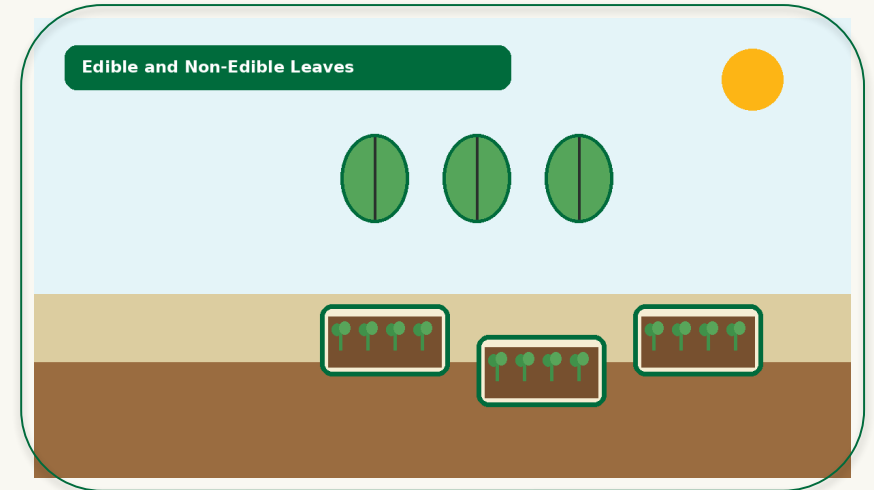
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare a two-stage sorting activity.

Edible and Non-Edible Leaves

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Identify approved edible leafy crops grown in the garden.
- Explain clearly that not every leaf is edible and pupils must never taste without permission.
- Connect edible leaves to familiar foods and meals.
- Use non-edible only to mean not approved as food in the lesson, avoiding unsafe identification games.
- Follow food hygiene and allergy procedures.



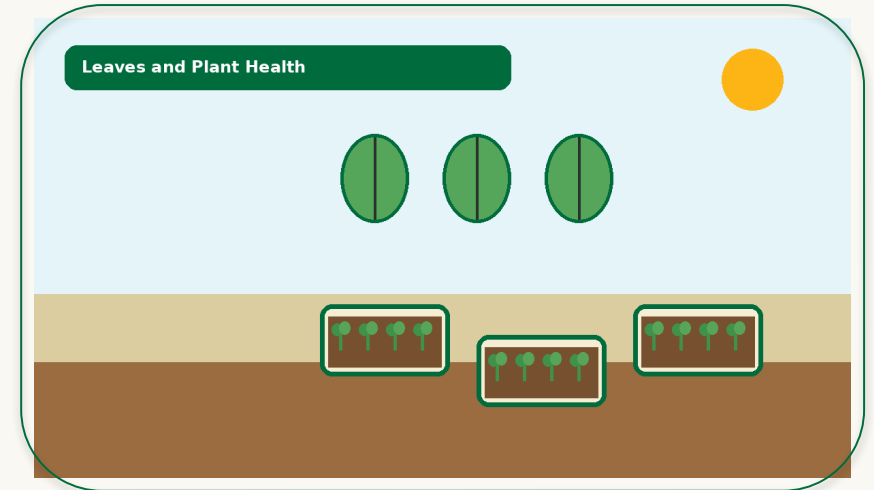
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare an approved edible-leaf display.

Leaves and Plant Health

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Observe wilting, holes, discoloration or damage as signs that invite further investigation.
- Do not diagnose disease from one visual symptom alone.
- Compare healthy-looking and visibly stressed leaves under teacher guidance.
- Connect observations to possible water, pest or physical-damage questions.
- Record changes over time before drawing conclusions.



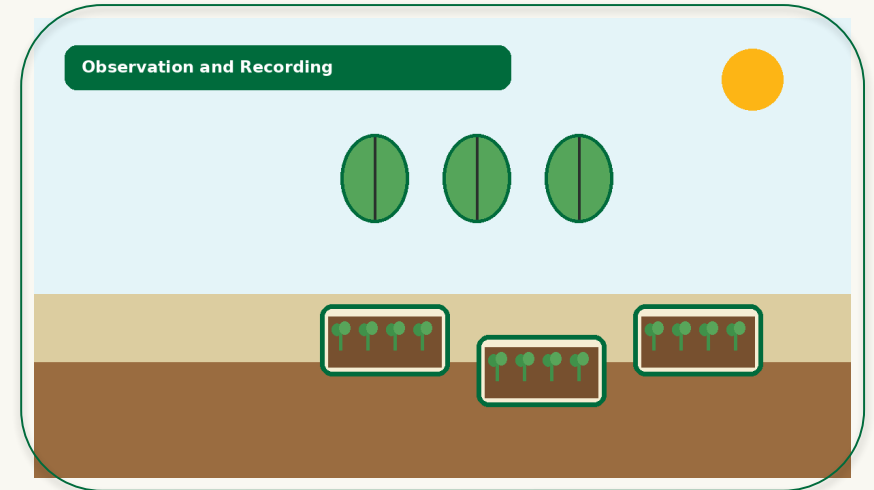
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Choose one plant for repeated health observation.

Observation and Recording

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Use date, crop name, drawing and 2-3 descriptive words.
- Teach pupils to record what they see rather than what they expect.
- Use simple measurements where appropriate.
- Revisit the same plant for change over time.
- Store records as part of a class garden journal.



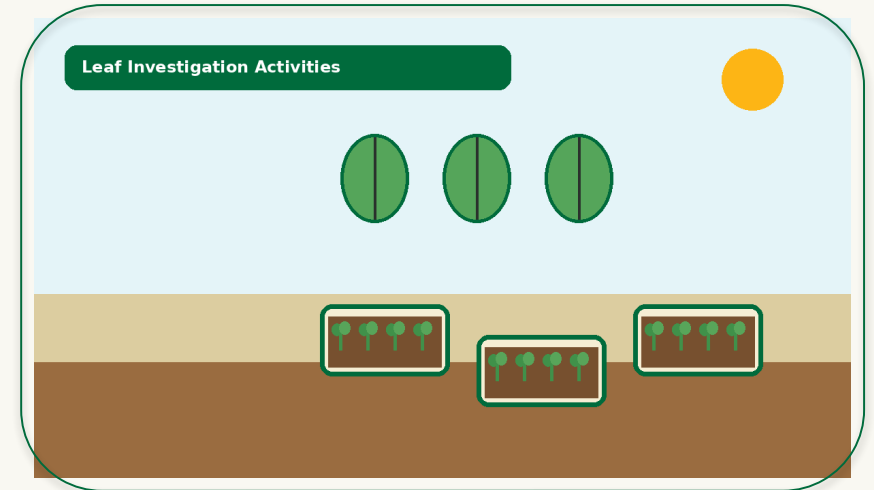
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Create a simple leaf observation sheet.

Leaf Investigation Activities

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Use matching, sorting, vein tracing from fallen leaves, observational drawing and safe comparison.
- Ask a question before each investigation.
- Use fallen leaves when handling could damage living plants.
- Keep art activities separate from scientific observation records when necessary.
- Share findings orally at the end.



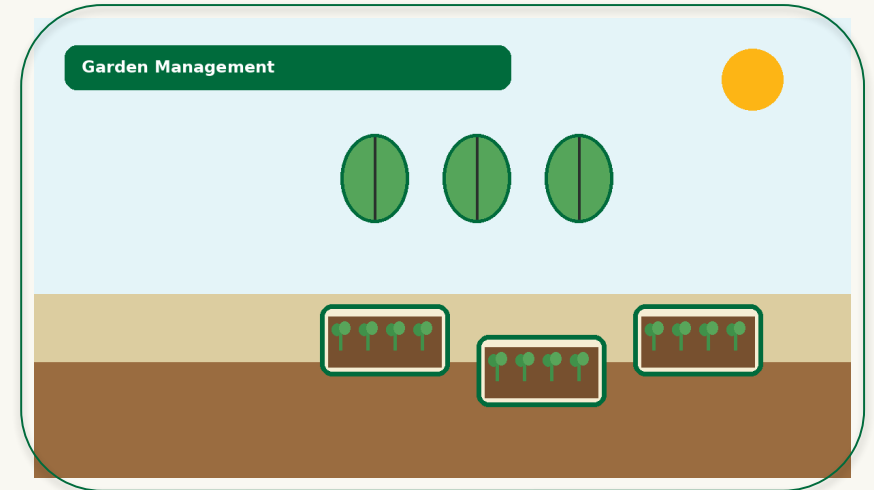
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Plan one question-based leaf investigation.

Garden Management

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Maintain labeled plants and accessible observation points.
- Remove diseased material according to garden procedures, not during unsupervised pupil handling.
- Avoid overharvesting leaves for activities.
- Keep paths and handwashing facilities ready.
- Coordinate leaf observation with crop-care schedules.



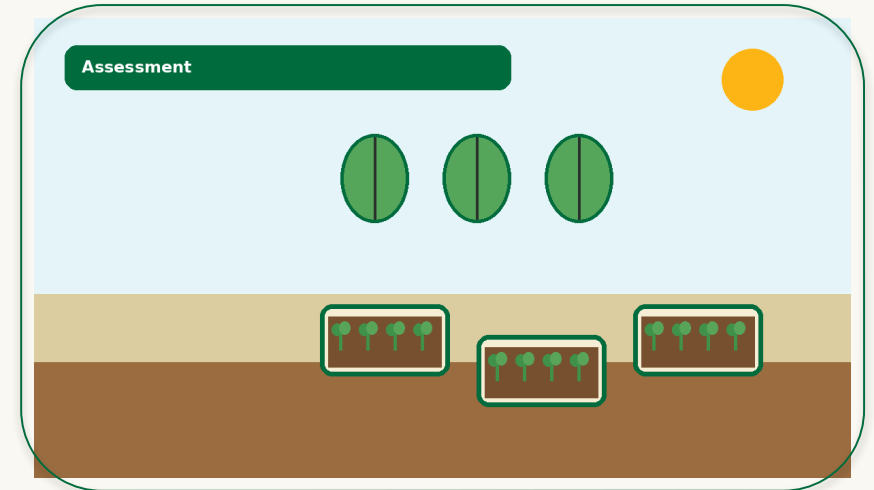
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare a weekly Leaf Garden check.

Assessment

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Assess identification of basic leaf parts, descriptive vocabulary, classification and observation records.
- Use real leaves or plants where safe.
- Ask pupils to explain their grouping rule.
- Evaluate accuracy of observation rather than artistic quality.
- Track improvement across repeated records.



TEACHER PRACTICE

- Completion task: design a Leaf Garden observation assessment.